

WILLIAM L. GAMBER

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Professional Experience

2024–present 2021–2024	Federal Reserve Board of Governors
	Senior Economist, Division of Research & Statistics Economist, Division of Research & Statistics
2016	Congressional Budget Office Summer Associate, Macroeconomic Analysis Division
2014–2015 2013–2014	Federal Reserve Board of Governors
	Senior Research Assistant, Division of Monetary Affairs Research Assistant, Division of Monetary Affairs

Education

2021	Ph.D. in Economics, New York University Dissertation: Essays in Firm Dynamics and Macroeconomics
2019	M.Phil. in Economics, New York University
2013	B.A. in Mathematics, <i>cum laude</i> , Pomona College

Working Papers

1. “Business Dynamics and Inflation Dynamics”

Abstract: I study how fluctuations in business formation and destruction affect inflation and the transmission of monetary policy. To do this, I study a New Keynesian model with endogenous business formation and destruction and heterogeneous firms. I show in the model that a decline in the number of firms puts upward pressure on inflation, and I find that it can quantitatively help explain the relatively muted disinflation that the U.S. experienced during the Great Recession. I then study the transmission of monetary policy in this framework. I show that endogenous fluctuations in entry generate an intertemporal trade-off in monetary policy; a contractionary policy shock leads employment and inflation to decline on impact, but inflation later overshoots, as the shock also leads entry to decline and exit to rise.

Refereed Publications

2. “The Importance of Entry in the Business Cycle: What Are the Roles of Markups, Adjustment Costs, and Heterogeneity?” (**Journal of Political Economy: Macroeconomics**, September 2023)

Abstract: In this paper, I evaluate the role of fluctuations in business formation in amplifying business cycles. To do this, I study the response of employment to shocks in a general equilibrium model of producer dynamics with entry and exit. The model features producer heterogeneity, adjustment frictions, and a variable demand elasticity. I find that while heterogeneity reduces the effects of entry on the broader economy, the variable demand elasticity and adjustment frictions amplify these effects, so that entry fluctuations lead to economically meaningful amplification of business cycle shocks.

3. "Stuck at Home: Housing Demand during the COVID-19 Pandemic" with James Graham and Anirudh Yadav (**Journal of Housing Economics, March 2023**)

Abstract: The COVID-19 pandemic induced a significant increase in both the amount of time that households spend at home and the share of expenditures allocated to at-home consumption. These changes coincided with a period of rapidly rising house prices. We interpret these facts as the result of stay-at-home shocks that increase demand for goods consumed at home as well as the homes that those goods are consumed in. We first test the hypothesis empirically using US cross-county panel data and instrumental variables regressions. We find that counties where households spent more time at home experienced faster increases in house prices. We then study various pandemic shocks using a heterogeneous agent model with general equilibrium in housing markets. Stay-at-home shocks explain around half of the increase in model house prices in 2020, with lower mortgage interest rates explaining around one third, and unemployment shocks and fiscal stimulus accounting for the remainder. We find that young households and first-time home buyers account for much of the increase in underlying housing demand during the pandemic, but they are largely crowded out of the housing market by the equilibrium rise in house prices.

Other publications

4. "Debt Payments and Spending: Evidence from the 2023 Student Loan Payment Restart" with Aditya Aladangady, Edmund Crawley, Patrick Moran, and Jose Nino" (**FEDS Note, September 2025**)

Abstract: In October 2023, roughly 40 million Americans faced a new monthly bill as federal student loan payments resumed after a three-year pandemic-induced pause. The restart of loan payments effectively reduced disposable income for borrowers, raising a critical question: How do debt payments affect household spending? In this note, we exploit a unique natural experiment and granular, ZIP-code-level data on consumer spending to better understand how changes in student loan payments and interest accrual affect household spending.

5. "Wealth Heterogeneity and Consumer Spending" with Samara Beach and Patrick Moran" (**FEDS Note, August 2025**)

Abstract: Economists have become increasingly interested in the effects of household heterogeneity on macroeconomic dynamics. In this note, we provide new evidence on the implications of wealth heterogeneity for consumer spending. In particular, we find that rising wealth concentration has reduced the average propensity to consume out of wealth, which helps to explain the weak recovery following the Great Recession.

6. "Winners and losers from recent asset price changes" with Edmund Crawley" (**FEDS Note, May 2023**)

Abstract: Asset prices and interest rates have changed dramatically and unexpectedly over the last two years as the Federal Reserve has raised its policy rate to combat higher inflation. In this note, we clarify the redistributive effects of these asset price changes in terms of welfare, which contrast sharply with those of wealth.

Referee Service

AEJ: Macroeconomics, BE Journal of Macroeconomics, The Economic Journal, Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization, Journal of Housing Economics, The Review of Economics and Statistics

Fellowships and Awards

2015-2020	MacCracken Fellowship, New York University
2013	Phi Beta Kappa